

Uddannelsesvalg i Danmark



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Botswana. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in Danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thank you for sharing a bit about yourself! It's great that you're thinking carefully about your next step — this will help set you up for success. Let's break down your options and some things to consider based on your background.

Your current situation

-  16 years old
-  Finished primary/lower secondary school (probably **Folkeskole** or equivalent)
-  Fluent in Danish
-  Danish-born with Botswanan heritage

Typical educational paths in Denmark after primary school

In Denmark, after primary/lower secondary school (9th or 10th grade), you usually choose between:

General upper secondary education (Gymnasiale uddannelser)

Designed for students who want to go to university later.

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** → Broad, academic, mix of humanities, sciences, social science
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination)** → Focus on business, economics, marketing
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination)** → Focus on technology, natural sciences
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)** → Shorter, 2 years, more practical, can be for older students or those wanting quicker path to further studies

Good if:

You want flexibility, might want to go to university, or are interested in academic subjects.

Vocational education and training (Erhvervsuddannelse / EUD)

Combines school and apprenticeship — direct path to a job (e.g., carpenter, electrician, chef, hairdresser, social care, IT, etc.)

👉 Good if:

You want to work sooner, prefer practical, hands-on learning, or already know what trade/skill you want.

3 Other options

- **International Baccalaureate (IB)** → If you want international focus and English instruction (might be interesting given your background)
- **10th grade (optional)** → If you want an extra year to decide, improve grades, or mature socially

💡 How to choose?

Ask yourself:

- ✓ Do I enjoy academic study and want to go to university? → Consider STX, HHX, HTX, or IB
- ✓ Am I excited about a specific trade or profession? → Consider EUD
- ✓ Do I want to keep options open but with some focus (e.g., business or technology)? → HHX or HTX
- ✓ Do I want an international perspective? → IB

🌐 Special tip

Since you have a multicultural background, you might also think about:

- Schools that offer global programs (e.g., IB, or schools with exchange opportunities)
- Considering language options (e.g., keeping up English, French, or other languages that could be useful if you're interested in working internationally or in Botswana one day)

🚀 My suggestion

Since you're still exploring:

- 👉 Consider visiting open house events (**Åbent Hus**) at local STX, HHX, HTX, or vocational schools.
- 👉 Talk to a guidance counselor (**UU-vejleder**) — they can help you explore your strengths and interests.
- 👉 If you enjoy academics and want flexibility for university, **STX** or **IB** could be good starting points.

If you tell me more about your interests (e.g., do you like science, languages, technology, business, hands-on work?) I can give a more personalized recommendation!

Would you like help mapping out possible schools or programs near where you live? Or help figuring out what your interests might point to? 😊